fieldwork

(2026-10-17)

Video production kit

Fieldwork · Practise AI on real work.

Video production kit

Version 0.1, 14 October 2026. For one person with a phone and no budget. Platform specs are marked *verify before use* because they change.

1. Principles

1. Show the task on screen. Faces are optional; the work is the star.
2. One idea, one task, one CTA per video.
3. Always show a check. Without a check it is just another AI demo.
4. Use only fictional or consented material. Use the fictional examples in the free exercise (weekly notes, Ankara order, economics notes, fictional flat).
5. Say what is illustrative. Never present a staged result as a live customer result.
6. Captions on every video. Many viewers watch without sound, and some cannot hear.

2. Gear (free or low cost)

ITEM	FREE / LOW-COST OPTION	ALTERNATIVES
Camera	Your phone, rear camera, 1080p, vertical 9:16 (verify platform specs)	Any recent phone
Tripod	Stack of books, or a £5 to £10 phone clamp (ASSUMPTION on price)	Lean the phone on a mug
Light	Window light, face the window; no overhead lights	A white sheet as a diffuser; a desk lamp with baking parchment as diffuser
Audio	Phone mic, quiet room, 20cm to 30cm from mouth	Wired earphones with a mic; clip-on mic (optional, around £10 to £20, ASSUMPTION)
Screen recording	iPhone: built-in recorder; Android: built-in recorder (verify per device); desktop: OBS Studio (free), or Xbox Game Bar on Windows (verify)	CapCut / Clipchamp for desktop
Editing	CapCut (free tier; verify features and terms), Clipchamp (free tier; verify)	DaVinci Resolve (free, heavier), InShot
Graphics	Canva free, Figma free	Keynote or Google Slides exported as images
Captions	Platform auto-captions, then correct by hand	CapCut auto-captions, then correct

3. Setup: talking head

1. Phone vertical at eye level, 40cm to 60cm away.
2. Face a window. No window behind you. Turn off fans and fridge noise.

3. Plain wall or tidy shelf. Chalk-coloured or off-white background is on brand but not necessary.
4. Do a 10-second test, play it back with headphones, check sound before the real take.
5. Record each line in short takes (one sentence each) so mistakes cost seconds.
6. Look at the lens for the first sentence; after that, glance at notes if needed.

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4. Setup: screen recording

1. Clear notifications (Do Not Disturb). Hide personal tabs, bookmarks, browser extensions.
2. Use a clean browser profile and a fictional account name. Never show your real emails, other chats, or private files.
3. Zoom the browser to 125% to 150% so text reads on a phone.
4. Record the voiceover separately in a quiet place if the room is noisy, then lay it over the clip.
5. Type slowly or paste prepared text. Cut dead time while loading.
6. Do not show an AI tool's output as "what the AI always says". Say "this is one run; yours will differ".
7. Only use a tool you can legitimately use. Do not record a paid plan you have not got.

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5. Brand look on screen

TOKEN	HEX	USE
Paper	#F3F2ED	Background cards
Ink	#121212	Text on paper; dark backgrounds
Cobalt	#2340FF	The one signal: results, key word, dot terrain; paper text on cobalt
Cobalt light	#7C8FFF	Cobalt on ink grounds
Wash	#E8E7E0	Secondary panels
Grey	#6B6A63	Muted text (use darker grey on wash)

Fonts: **Schibsted Grotesk** (bold for hook and headline cards, regular for body text and captions) and **Geist Mono** for labels such as `(01) BRIEF`, `CHECK`, `STEP 2`. Both are free from Google Fonts (SIL OFL; verify licence terms on the font page). CapCut may not include them: use Canva (free; uploading fonts needs a paid plan, verify) or fall back to the nearest available (a tight bold grotesque for headlines, a monospace for labels). Keep contrast: ink on paper (about 16.7:1), paper on cobalt (about 5.8:1; large text only below 18px). Do not use grey as small text on wash.

On-screen text style

- Hook card (first 2 seconds): Schibsted Grotesk Bold, tight tracking (-6%), 64 to 80pt equivalent on 1080x1920, ink on paper, max 8 words.
- Labels: Geist Mono uppercase, small, cobalt on paper: `(01) BRIEF`.
- Body overlays: Schibsted Grotesk 36 to 44pt, max 2 lines, ink on paper panel; avoid text in the bottom 20% and top 10% (UI overlays; verify safe zones per platform).
- One highlight per scene using cobalt (colour or underline). No emojis in on-screen text. No flashy transitions. Cuts or 150ms fades only.
- Use hairline rules, corner letters and dot terrain, matching the site.

- Keep text on screen at least 1 second per 4 words.

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6. Video specs (verify before use)

- Vertical 9:16, 1080x1920, 30fps. Duration 20 to 60 seconds. Check each platform's current max length and cover-image rules.
- Export H.264 MP4 (verify). Keep file under platform limits.
- Cover/thumbnail: pick a frame with the hook card or create a 1080x1920 still. Keep important text within the central safe area (verify).
- Low data audiences: do not upload 4K. Keep files small; offer text carousels as an alternative on days when video is not possible.

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7. Thumbnail template

Layout (paper background): top-left Geist Mono label `(FIELDWORK · CHECK IT)` in cobalt. Centre: hook in Schibsted Grotesk Bold, ink, 3 to 6 words. Bottom: a hairline rule and a small line `Free exercise · no account`; the giant wordmark may be cropped at the very bottom. No faces needed. No stock photo unless licensed. Variations: ink background with paper text, or cobalt background for "Check it" videos.

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8. Caption templates

Keep captions short; the post is the content. Replace bracketed parts. Add the link in the platform-appropriate place (bio link, pinned comment, description; verify what each platform allows).

Task demo

> [Task] in [seconds]. Brief, run, check, keep. The check is the part most people skip. Free exercise, about 15 minutes, no account: [link] Illustrative example. Your result from your own tool will differ.

Check it

> [Mistake in one sentence]. Ask the tool: "[follow-up prompt]". Then check it yourself. Free: [link]

Safety

> Before you paste it into an AI tool at work: green, amber or red? Rules and settings differ by tool and plan. This is general guidance, not legal advice. [link]

Honest status

> Today: one free exercise and four short articles. Planned, not on sale: guided projects and membership. Early access: one email when something real is ready. [link]

Hashtags: see `SOCIAL-KIT.md` (verify before use).

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9. Ten short-video scripts

Run time 30 to 60 seconds. "VO" is voiceover. Replace [link] with a UTM link. Keep the pace plain.

V1. What Fieldwork is (honest status) · Day 1 · 45s

Goal: explain the offer and its status. **Shot list:** (1) talking head, (2) screen recording of the first workflow page, (3) simple two-column text card Live / Planned, (4) closing talking head. **VO:** "I'm building Fieldwork, a place to practise AI on real work. Here is what exists today. One free guided exercise: you write a brief, run it in whichever AI tool you already use, check the result, and keep a workflow card. No account. About fifteen minutes. And four short articles. Here is what does not exist yet: guided projects and a membership. They are planned. They are not on sale. If you want one email when something real is ready, there's an early-access list. Otherwise, try the exercise and tell me where it fell short." **On-screen text:** `LIVE: free exercise, 4 Field Notes` / `PLANNED, NOT ON SALE: guided projects, membership`. **CTA:** Try the free exercise (link in bio). **Caption:** honest-status template.

V2. Five-part brief on a weekly update · Day 3 · 45s

Shot list: (1) hook card, (2) paste notes (fictional), (3) thin prompt "write me a weekly update" and generic result, (4) fill the five parts, (5) better result, (6) text card "Still check it", (7) CTA card. **VO:** "Stop typing 'write me an update'. Here is the same notes page two ways. Thin prompt, generic answer. Now a brief in five parts. Task: a short update for my manager. Audience: someone with two minutes. Tone: plain and calm. Shape: three headings, under one hundred and fifty words. Rules: keep dates and amounts exactly as written, and don't add praise. Better. But it's still a draft. Check it against your notes. The free exercise walks you through it." **On-screen text:** `1 TASK 2 AUDIENCE 3 TONE 4 SHAPE 5 RULES`. **CTA:** Free exercise.

V3. The credit note error · Day 6 · 40s

Shot list: notes on left, draft on right; highlight "still to be issued" vs "has been issued"; show follow-up prompt; show corrected draft. **VO:** "The AI said the credit note had been issued. My notes said it was still to be issued. One small word, and your manager thinks the job is done. Here's the check. Pick three details: a date, a name, an amount. Find each in your own notes, not in your memory. Then ask the tool: check your answer against my notes, line by line, and quote the part each detail came from. This example is illustrative, written to show how checking works. Try it on your own task." **On-screen text:** `NOTES: "still to be issued"` vs `DRAFT: "has been issued"`; label `ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE`. **CTA:** Free exercise.

V4. What not to paste · Day 9 · 45s

Shot list: traffic-light graphic with three beats; talking head over. **VO:** "Before you paste anything into an AI tool at work, ask: green, amber or red? Red: passwords, bank or card details, identity documents. Keep those out. Amber: internal procedures, customer messages. Swap names for placeholders like CLIENT and ADDRESS, and check your company's rules. Green: your own drafts and public information. Rules and settings differ by tool and plan, so read yours. This is general guidance, not legal advice. The full guide is a short article on the site." **On-screen text:** `RED / AMBER / GREEN` with examples. **CTA:** Read the Field Note: What not to paste.

V5. Reply to a late order · Day 11 · 50s

Shot list: (1) fictional customer message on phone; (2) brief with facts and rules; (3) result; (4) check with one highlighted promise; (5) CTA. **VO:** "A customer's order is late. They need it for a wedding. You know the facts, but your draft sounds defensive. Give the tool your facts and one rule: don't promise anything that isn't in my facts. Ask for under ninety words and one clear next step. Now check it. My facts say the new date is the eighteenth. Does the draft say the eighteenth? Yes. Does it promise anything earlier? No. Good. If it had, I'd fix that line. The customer and order here are fictional." **On-screen text:** `FACTS: new date 18 Oct · refund delivery fee · cannot promise earlier`. **CTA:** Free exercise.

V6. Study notes that quiz you · Day 15 · 45s

Shot list: dense paragraph; brief; five points + three questions; checking one answer against the text. **VO:** "Re-reading your notes isn't working. Try this. Paste your own notes and say: use only my text. If a point is unclear, say so. Give me five key points, then three questions to test whether I understood. Now answer one question yourself, and check it against your text. If the tool added an example you didn't give it, that's an invented detail. Cut it. Use it to understand, and follow your school's rules on AI." **On-screen text:** `USE ONLY MY TEXT`. **CTA:** Free exercise.

V7. Ask the AI to find its invented claims · Day 17 · 40s

Shot list: draft with highlighted invented sentence; prompt on screen; list result. **VO:** "Here is a prompt that helps. 'List every statement in your answer that is not directly supported by my material. Then rewrite the answer without them.' The tool can miss things, so you still check. But it points you to the sentences to look at first. That's quicker than reading everything twice." **On-screen text:** the prompt in Geist Mono; `STILL CHECK IT`. **CTA:** Free exercise.

V8. Free tools, light on data · Day 20 · 40s

Shot list: phone screen recording of the exercise; data saver mode screen (do not show settings that identify you). **VO:** "You don't need a paid tool or a fast connection to start. The exercise is text, no video to stream, and no account. Paste the prompt into the free version of whichever AI tool you already use. Free tools change what they allow, so check the limits on yours. And your entries stay on your device." **On-screen text:** `TEXT ONLY · NO ACCOUNT · FREE TOOLS`. **CTA:** Free exercise. **Check before posting:** confirm "entries stay on device" against the live page; do not quote data usage figures unless you measured them.

V9. Listing from verified facts · Day 22 · 50s

Shot list: fictional facts sheet; brief with rules; draft; check "anything not in facts?". **VO:** "You have verified facts about a flat. You want a draft listing. The risk is a lovely draft with a garden that doesn't exist. Rules: only the facts. Mention tenure and service charge. No 'stunning'. No neighbourhood claims. Now check every sentence against the fact sheet. The property here is fictional, written for practice." **On-screen text:** `FICTIONAL PROPERTY` always visible. **CTA:** Free exercise or Field Note on property tasks.

V10. Build notes · Day 27 · 50s

Goal: truthfully share what changed. **Only record this if you have real learnings. Shot list:** talking head; screen of tracker (hide private data). **VO template:** "Four weeks of posting. What I learned. What worked: [real]. What didn't: [real]. What I'm changing: [real]. What's still unproven: [real]. Not on sale yet: guided projects and membership. If you want to shape what I build, tell me which task you'd want guided." **Rule:** quote only measured numbers, with sample sizes. If nothing changed, post the honest-status version of V1 instead. **CTA:** Tell me what task to cover next (comment) or early access.

10. Editing checklist

- [ ] First two seconds show the hook text and the task.
- [ ] Cut every pause longer than half a second.
- [ ] No private data visible (emails, tabs, notifications, names).
- [ ] Fictional/illustrative label visible where used.
- [ ] Captions on, checked word by word (names, numbers, British spellings).
- [ ] Brand colours and fonts consistent.
- [ ] CTA appears in the last 3 seconds and in the caption.
- [ ] Audio levels consistent; music (if any) well below voice.
- [ ] Facts verified against the live site (what's live vs planned).
- [ ] Export, watch on a phone, with and without sound.
- [ ] UTM link tested.

11. Accessibility

- Burn-in or upload captions in plain British English. Use sentence case, high contrast, 2 lines max.
- Do not rely on colour alone to distinguish red/amber/green; add words.
- Provide alt text on image posts (see `SOCIAL-KIT.md`).
- Speak at a steady pace; avoid slang that does not travel between the UK and Nigeria.
- Avoid flashing visuals. Keep text readable at small size.
- If a video is about text on a screen, read key lines aloud as well.

12. Music and licensing caution

- Default: no music, or very quiet licensed music. Voice and captions carry the content.
- Do not use commercial tracks. Use only music licensed for your use. Platform music libraries are often limited to personal accounts; business accounts may have different rules (verify before use).

- Free music sources have different licences and attribution rules (verify before use). Keep a record of the source, licence and date for every track.
- Do not use recognisable voices, characters or logos of tools or companies as if endorsed. Refer to tools by name only to say what you did.
- Stock footage: only use items you are licensed to use; the site's own imagery has credits in `docs/website/IMAGE-CREDITS.md`.
- AI-generated voices or avatars: if used, disclose and follow platform labelling rules (verify before use). Not recommended in the first 30 days: the brand promise is a real person who tried it.